ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

REPORT ON GLENVIEW SOUTH CONSTITUENCY AND RUSHINGA RURAL DISTRICT COUNCIL WARD 19 BY-ELECTIONS HELD ON 12 APRIL 2025

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Executive Summary

1. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.
2. Its functions are provided for in *Section 239* of the said Constitution.

3. Honourable Grandmore Hakata was elected in the 2023 General Elections into the National Assembly representing Glenview South constituency. He passed on, on 23 January 2025. The President issued Proclamation 1 of 2025 calling for a National Assembly by-election.

   The Commission also issued a ZEC Notice on 19 February 2025 calling for a Local Authority by-election following the death of Councillor Howard Machipisa of Ward 19 Rushinga Rural District Council thus harmonizing the by-elections on 12 April 2025.

4. The Commission submitted a combined budget of ZWG27 766 616 for the by-elections. However, Treasury released ZWG11 140 000 for Glenview South Constituency and ZWG3 967 152 for Rushinga RDC Ward 19 by-elections totalling ZWG15 107 152.

5. The Commission conducted voter education exercises for the pre-nomination and pre-polling phases. The pre-nomination messages centred on the cause of the by-election, and candidate qualifications. The pre-polling messages centred on how to vote.

6. The Nomination Courts to receive nomination papers for candidates to stand for election as Councillor for Ward 19 Rushinga Rural District Council and as Member of the National Assembly for Glenview South constituency sat on 12 and 13 March 2025 respectively. The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of sitting of the Nomination Courts:

WARD 19 RUSHINGA RURAL DISTRICT COUNCIL CANDIDATES

Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Rushinga RDC	19	Kahwiti Itai	M	INDEPENDENT
		Madzinga Trinity	M	ZANU PF

GLENVIEW SOUTH NATIONAL ASSEMBLY CANDIDATES

Constituency	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Glenview South	Chakeredza Tonderai	M	INDEPENDENT
	Madzokere Tungamirai	M	INDEPENDENT
	Makwangwaidze George	M	INDEPENDENT
	Mukanda Perpetua	F	NCA
	Tawomhera Tranquility Tsitsi	F	ZANU PF

7. A total of thirty-three thousand seven hundred **(33 700)** ballot papers were printed for Glenview South National Assembly by-election, while one thousand seven hundred (**1 700**) ballot papers were printed for the Rushinga Ward 19 local authority by-election. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

8. The Commission established forty-seven (47) polling stations for voting purposes broken down as follows: Forty-three (43) for Glenview South Constituency and four (4) for Rushinga RDC Ward 19. These were advertised in terms of the law.

9 The Commission used its own fleet of vehicles for the by-elections.

10. The training of electoral officers for different categories was conducted from 27 March to 10 April 2025. Each polling station was staffed with seven (7) Polling Officers including the Presiding Officer.

11. Applications for the accreditation of observers were received and processed on time.

12. Polling took place on 12 April 2025 and results were announced on 13 April 2025.

13. Tranquility Tsitsi Tawomhera of ZANU PF party was declared the winner after polling the majority of votes in the Glenview South National Assembly Constituency contest.

Madzinga Trinity of ZANU PF party was declared the winner after polling the majority of votes in the Ward 19 Rushinga Rural District contest.

14. The by-elections were held under peaceful conditions.

CHAPTER 1:

THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

1.1 Composition

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of the Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

It is composed of a Chairperson appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders and eight other members appointed by the President from a list of not fewer than twelve nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

At the time of the by-election, the Commission consisted of a full board of nine members as follows:

1. Honourable Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba - Chairperson
2. Ambassador Rodney Simukai Kiwa - Deputy Chairperson
3. Mr Jasper Mangwana - Commissioner
4. Mrs Abigail Millicent Mohadi Ambrose - Commissioner
5. Mr Shepherd Manhivi - Commissioner
6. Ms Catherine Mpofu - Commissioner
7. Mrs Rosewita Murutare - Commissioner
8. Dr Janet Mbetu Nzvenga - Commissioner
9. Dr Kudzai Shava - Commissioner

1.2 Functions of the Commission

The functions of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission are provided for in Section 239 of the Constitution as follows:

a. to prepare for, conduct and supervise –

(i) elections to the office of President and to Parliament;

(ii) elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities;

(iii) elections of members of the National Council of Chiefs established by section 285; and

(iv) referendums;

and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with the law,

b. to supervise elections of the President of the Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that these elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. to register voters;

d. to compile voters' rolls and registers,

e. to ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voters rolls and registers;

f. to delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. to design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. to conduct and supervise voter education;

i. to accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. to give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purpose of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. to receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

1.3 Additional Functions

The Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] in Section 5 thereof provides for additional functions and powers of the Commission as follows:

a. undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters

b. developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to the electoral processes; and

c. promoting co-operation between Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and

d. keeping the public informed about -

   i. the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise; and

   ii. the delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries, and

   iii. the location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open for inspection; and

   iv. voters rolls and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and

   v. political parties and candidates contesting every election and;

   vi. voting; and

   vii. generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and

d1. ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and

e. making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

Chapter II:

2.0 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS

2.1 Proclamation 1 of 2025of 21 February 2025.

Following the notification of a vacancy which arose in Parliament due to the death of the Citizens Coalition for Change (CCC) member of the National Assembly, for Glenview South Constituency Honourable Grandmore Hakata on 23 January 2025, the President issued Proclamation 1 of 2025 calling for by-elections in the said constituency to be held on 12 April 2025.

The Commission also issued a ZEC Notice on 19 February 2025 calling for a Local Authority by-election after receiving notification of the death of Ward 19 Councillor in the Rushinga Rural District Council. The National Assembly and Local Authority by-elections were harmonised and held on the same date.

2.2 Voter Education

The Commission conducted pre-nomination and pre-polling voter education for the said by-elections during the period between 25 February and 13 March 2025.The key messages for the pre-nomination phase centred on sensitizing the electorate on the existence of the vacancies, the requirements for nomination of candidates and the ward and constituency boundaries. The pre-polling voter education emphasised on preparing the electorate on the contesting candidates, correct documentation to carry, the polling date and times, polling station specific voting, the voting process and how to cast a vote and encouraging the electorate to go and vote.

The voter education teams used various methodologies to educate the electorate such as the door-to-door visits, interaction with individuals and addressing of gatherings, use of posters, distribution of pamphlets and flyers and use of the Public Address (PA) System.

2.3 Nomination Court Results

The Nomination Courts to receive nomination papers for candidates to stand for election for Ward 19 of Rushinga RDC and Glenview South Constituency sat on 12 and 13 March 2025

respectively. The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of the sitting of the Nomination Courts:

Ward 19 Rushinga Rural District Council Candidates

Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Rushinga RDC	19	Kahwiti Itai	M	INDEPENDENT
		Madzinga Trinity	M	ZANU PF

Glenview South National Assembly Candidates

Constituency	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Glenview South	Chakeredza Tonderai	M	INDEPENDENT
	Madzokere Tungamirai	M	INDEPENDENT
	Makwangwaidze George	M	INDEPENDENT
	Mukanda Perpetua	F	NCA
	Tawomhera Tranquility Tsitsi	F	ZANU PF

2.4 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates

The Commission provided the candidates with electronic copies of the voters' roll for their respective elections. The polling stations, Ward and the Constituency Command Centres were each furnished with a copy of the voters roll for use on polling day, as well as an additional copy (without pictures) for display in order for voters to check their names before polling day.

2.5 Multiparty Liaison Committee

Both Glenview South National Assembly constituency and Ward 19 Rushinga RDC candidates and stakeholders held three multiparty liaison committee meetings each. The meetings were successful as stakeholders resolved all tabled issues without challenges.

2.6 Polling Stations

The Commission established forty-seven (47) polling stations for the 12 April 2025 by-elections broken down as follows: Forty-three (43) for Glenview South Constituency and four (4) for Rushinga RDC Ward 19 and these were published in the print media.

2.7 Ballot Paper Printing

A total of thirty-three thousand seven hundred (33 700) ballot papers were printed for the Glenview South National Assembly constituency with one thousand seven hundred (1 700) ballot papers printed for Ward 19 Rushinga RDC. The printer was the Minting and Printing Company of Zimbabwe. This information was published in line with the law.

2.8 Transport

The Commission used its own vehicle fleet during the by-elections. Each polling station and command centre was allocated a vehicle and this made the process of deployment, transmission of results, decamping and supervision efficient.

2.9 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers

Personnel to conduct the by-elections were drawn mainly from the ZEC Secretariat staff, the Public Service Commission and the respective Local Authorities.

2.10 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel

The accreditation of observers and the media commenced after the publication of the Proclamation and the ZEC Notice. Accreditation teams were deployed at Allan Wilson High School in Harare for Glenview South Constituency and Nyamanyanya Primary School for Ward 19 Rushinga RDC. Eleven (11) local observers and sixteen (16) local media personnel were accredited for the Glenview South Constituency by-election.

Chapter III

3.0 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING

3.1 Polling

Polling took place on 12 April 2025 commencing at 0700 hours and ending at 1900 hours. Due regard was given to the provision that no voter in the queue of persons waiting to vote as at 1900 hours would be turned away.

Every polling station was staffed with electoral officers whose number varied depending on the voter population.

In addition to the electoral officers, there were candidates, election agents and observers. Police officers provided security and performed other duties as provided for in the law.

Only one (1) distinctly marked ballot box was set up in each polling station.

3.2 Results of polls

The summary of the results for the by-elections was as follows:

By-election	***Candidates' Names***	***Sex***	***Party***	***Votes***	***Remarks***
Glenview South National Assembly Constituency	Chakeredza Tonderai	M	INDEPENDENT	993	
	Madzokere Tungamirai	M	INDEPENDENT	234	
	Makwangwadze George	M	INDEPENDENT	681	
	Mukanda Perpetua	F	NCA	77	
	Tawomhera Tranquility Tsitsi	F	ZANU PF	**3404**	**Winner**
			Rejected Votes	**44**	
			Total	**5433**	
			Voter Population	**31519**	
			% Turn-Out	**17.2**	

By-election	**Candidates' Names**	**Sex**	**Party**	**Votes**	**Remarks**
Ward 19 Rushinga RDC	Kahwiti Itai	M	INDEPENDENT	19	
	Madzinga Trinity	M	ZANU PF	784	**Winner**
			Rejected Votes	**9**	
			Total	**812**	
			Voter Population	**1578**	
			% Turn-Out	**51.5**	

3.3 Voter Turnout in Comparison to 2023

The voter turnout for the by-elections as compared to the 2023 harmonised elections was as follows: -

Election	2023 Harmonised Elections	12 April 2025 By-elections
Glenview South National Assembly Constituency	60.0%	17.2%
Ward 19 Rushinga RDC	82.0%	51.5%

Both by-elections witnessed a decrease in voter turnout.

3.4 The Environment

The political environment was calm. There were no reported cases of politically motivated violence for the by-elections.

Chapter IV

4.0 BUDGET

4.1 Budget

The Commission submitted a combined budget of ZWG27 766 616 for the by-elections. However, Treasury only released ZWG11 140 000 for Glenview South Constituency and ZWG3 967 152 for Rushinga RDC Ward 19 by-elections totalling to ZWG15 107 152.

4.2 Budget Control

The Commission applied all financial statutory guidelines in line with the law.

Chapter V:

5.0 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

The Commission made some observations and recommendations as presented below:

5.1 Budget

Observation

There is a notable difference between the budgetary requirements requested and the amounts released by Treasury.

Recommendation

Treasury should avail in full the requested budgetary requirements in order for the Commission to efficiently discharge its constitutional obligations.

5.2 Late Release of Electoral Funds

Observation

The budget for electoral processes is not being released on time.

Recommendation

The budget for electoral processes should be timeously released to enable the Commission to smoothly prepare for same.

5.3 Rising costs of goods and services

Observation

The prices of goods and services continue to soar whilst allocations remain static and this has an effect of retarding activities linked to the electoral process.

Recommendations

The Commission should be funded according to the current market prices to counter fluctuations in prices of goods and services essential for election administration.

5.4 Conclusion

The Commission consulted and worked in collaboration with its stakeholders throughout the election period ensuring that the process was inclusive and transparent. The Commission is satisfied that the 12 April 2025 by-elections were conducted in a manner and under conditions that allowed voters to freely express their will.

Signed:  Date: 25 July 2025

Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba

ZEC Chairperson